Now that ACME plans to sell the platform to external customers, these shortcuts are no longer sufficient. Each tenant must have its own workspace, administrators, and policies for sharing and delegation. What was once a single trusted environment must become hundreds of isolated ones. ACME's engineers need a way to enforce consistent, auditable rules without rewriting every service while giving customers limited control over their access policies.

This chapter explores how ACME integrated a policy engine into an existing system. We'll follow their shift from hard-coded checks to externalized authorization, showing how Cedar policies seamlessly fit into an architecture made up of gateways, microservices, and identity providers. Throughout, we'll examine practical integration patterns, multi-tenant governance, and lessons learned from ACME's deployment.

By the end of the chapter, you'll see that adopting a policy engine isn't a switch you flip all at once. Instead, it's a gradual process of externalizing decisions, connecting data sources, and aligning policy with identity. ACME's story shows how dynamic authorization can grow within the systems you already use, one enforcement point at a time.